and turns, the Test and the series remained in the balance. Every single run really did count.

We desperately needed a wicket. Mitchell Johnson stroked Imran for two boundaries through the off-side. The score moved to 276 for six, and just 34 were needed when we took the second new ball. This was our chance, and Haddin finally feathered a catch to Boucher. Siddle came in and hit a boundary, but then fell to Dale. Was the momentum shifting again? They were 292 for eight, still 18 runs short, and we required two more wickets.

Pat Cummins, aged 18, arrived at the crease with a grand total of 27 runs in first-class and limited-overs cricket, and we were swarming all over him. A leading edge produced three more runs. Up in the media seats, a journalist typed into his laptop: 'Four seasons of IPL cricket have not produced anything like this.'

The margins were tiny and, after surviving a series of close calls, Johnson and Cummins took their team to 310, securing a victory that Clarke described as 'unbelievable'. The series was drawn 1–1 ...

There are plenty of knowledgeable people in the game who seriously doubt whether Test cricket will be played a decade or so from now. It may have been an epic Test at the Wanderers, they would say, but the last day was played in an almost-empty stadium and, ultimately, there will be no Tests if there is no crowd.

Personally, I am not overly concerned about the future of Test cricket. The commercial reality that ODIs and T20s draw large crowds and generate 95% of the revenue is clear, but the popularity of limited-overs cricket does not mean there is no room for Tests, particularly when the entertainment remains as exceptional as it was at Wanderers in 2011, and when the longer format of the game continues to be enjoyed by a core audience.

Go to Newlands for the New Year Test, or watch the Christmas and New Year Tests in Australia, or attend any Test match played in